



Havok

Whenever you blowup an enemy to bits or kick someone's a\$\$ from here to kingdom come, chances are it looks realistic because of the Havok engine. Some of the best in game physics in some of the



best games ever created have run on this ubiquitous physics engine. The collisions, ragdoll effects and scatter trajectories rendered by the engine make games ultra realistic. *Bioshock 2*, *F.E.A.R. 2*, *Half-life 2*, *The Witcher 2* and many more on the A-list of gaming implement the Havok engine. The best part is that it's cross platform, also supporting Xbox 360, PS variants Linux, Mac and recently even Android.



John Carmack

What do *Dangerous Dave*, *Quake*, *Doom*, id and Apogee have in common? Apart from being etched in the memory of almost every gamer, what they have in common is John Carmack. The legendary game



programmer and the co-founder of id Software has had a strong hand

in shaping the gaming industry from its very beginnings. He developed several techniques – binary space partitioning, surface caching, and megatextures, which gave each of his games a never before seen visual appeal. He's also an open source geek, having released the source code of Quake for Linux very early on.

120,000

Is the number of people that the American videogame industry employs either directly or indirectly. Of these the people employed directly have an average salary of \$90,000 and together they generate or \$25 billion in annual revenue.



God of War

Arguably one of the best games ever in the console space, Kratos redefined a\$\$ kicking. Heck, some would go so far as to call it the best game ever. So what if it turns mythology on it's head so much to make historians roll over in their graves? The game gave us some of the best and never before experienced gruesome thrills in any hack-n-slash. Even when it debuted on the PSP, *God of War* was the first game to stretch the device to it's absolute breaking point. For a tile like GoW, Sony let developers go beyond the 222MHz cap, stretching the PSP to its full potential of 333 MHz.



Quake III

Yes it's obvious, but what did you expect? We've been obsessed with the game for the past 9 years! Even today every machine at Digit has *Quake III* installed and is evoked at every issue closing. In fact, just before writing this piece a fierce one-on-one, instagib death match in DM17 ended with a score of 115-87. Anyhoo, *QIII* gave us so many things – strafe jumping, rocket jumping, rocket prediction, the railgun (to use on human players)! Nuff said.



TGS

Thank God it's Sunday? Nope. Tokyo Game Show! A place that is part fantasy and part reality. A place where every gamer's wildest dreams come true. OK. We are exaggerating, but TGS is surely the place to be if you're a gamer. Like Gamescom, you have the who's who of gaming showcasing products, letting visitors try out never-seen-before tech and of course you have hundreds of arcade games lined up, hot booth babes dressed as your favourite game characters. There's more: a dedicated mobile gaming area, kid's area and an enclosure for careers in gaming.



Xbox

It's quite understandable if the Xbox brand name doesn't bring to mind images of grandeur. But the console



does have several industry firsts to its credit. At a time when the realm of HD or High Definition had not yet been breached, Xbox 360 showed its early adopters what it was like to experience graphics in HD. We're not saying great graphics, just HD. Way before this achievement, Xbox debuted its Xbox live service and gave console users a taste of what PC gamers were enjoying for some time till then.



133t

If you don't want to be called a n00b and get pwn3d, you need to level up to be 133t. The term

Leet evolved from the word elite and is now used to describe exceptionally skilled gamers and hackers. The writing style developed as an esoteric

form made up of ASCII characters and errors that happen while frantically chatting during intense multiplayer sessions. Now it's almost a subculture that alienates non-gamers.

